On 13 May AD 1507, Babur rode out of Kābul. He was intending to overrun the Ghiljīs. But when Babur had dismounted at Sar-i-dih, he was told that several Mahmands (Afghāns) were lying in Masht and Sih-kāna around five miles from his location. It was then that the begs of Babur yelled in agreement, 'The Mahmands must be over-run.'

Babur replied, 'Would it be right to turn aside and raid our own peasants instead of doing what we set out to do? It cannot be.'[33]

Riding from Sar-i-dih, Babur crossed the plain of Kattawāz in the ghastly dark of the night. At one stretch of the land, there appeared no mountain or hill. Nor the road appeared known. None agreed to lead, prompting Babur to take up the task. He had been on this route on several occasions earlier. Reminiscing on the lingering memories of the past journeys, he began to lead. By the grace of Allah, as Babur has written, his guidance proved to be right. They went straight to the Qīāq-tū and the Aūlābā-tū torrent. They reached the Khwāja Ismā'īl Sirītī road which crossed the two torrents and where the Ghiljīs were stationed. Babur and his men dismounted near the torrent. They slept and let the horse rest too till dawn. They resumed their march. Sun had elevated to a good height before they could get out of those low hills. The Ghiljīs were lying at the bottom of the valley and the plains quite a few miles away. Once Babur was out of the plain, he could see the darkness in the sky caused by the smoke of fire started by the Ghiljīs.

Suddenly, Babur and his army began to gallop. Perhaps they wanted to hurry the conquest for some reason. They shot many arrows at the Ghiljīs, subsequently conquering tribe. It would have been very difficult to get 6000 galloping soldiers in control and hence Babur chose to go with the flow. The raid was a success. Babur was quite delighted to have extorted way more sheep in this raid than any other in the recent past.

Babur's men loaded the spoils and began to ride back. But in the tourney, the Afghāns men kept coming, trying to provoke a fight. Babur and his men spared none. All were slaughtered and yet again a tower of skulls was set up.

Babur talks of only one loss in this battle. It was Dost the Kotwal on whose feet an arrow had pierced. He couldn't survive till Babur's troop reached Kābul.

Marching from Khwāja Ismā'īl, Babur and his men dismounted once more at Aūlābā-tū. Some of the begs and households of Babur were instructed to go forward and carefully separate one-fifth[34] of the enemy's spoils. Babur was quite favourable to Qāsim Beg and other allied begs. He writes in the *Baburnama*:[*]